

[< BACK](#)[🏠 Gaming Law Review](#) > **Vol. 26, No. 3**Research Article [🔒 FREE ACCESS](#) Published Online: 8 April 2022

Uncle Stanley, The Dancing King of Gambling Who Promised and Delivered the Moon

Authors: [Pedro Cortés](#) and [António Lobo Vilela](#) | [AUTHORS INFO & AFFILIATIONS](#)Publication: Gaming Law Review <https://doi.org/10.1089/glr2.2021.0025>[Permissions & Citations](#)[PDF/EPUB](#)

Gaming has always been a passion for Chinese people, and its practice in Macau¹ has been recorded over hundreds of years. The Portuguese authorities had tolerated it from the sixteenth century, and there was never a stated prohibition. It was a popular activity played on every corner and boat, and in every meeting place in Macau.²

Macau's history is ineluctably the history of the gaming industry³ and such industry—legalized in 1849⁴ by Governor Ferreira do Amaral, beginning the Fantan Era⁵—has created charismatic entrepreneurs. One of them, who contributed most to the development of the industry, was Stanley Ho Hung-sun (何鴻燊), who passed away last year at the age of 99, leaving behind 16 children from four different wives. Before Stanley Ho got his concession, other *taipan* (top-level businesspeople) had occupied, to a certain extent, his position. Tracing the historical journey of those charismatic leaders since the activity was legalized in 1849 takes time, but it is worthwhile to know who they were.



[< BACK](#)

Lou Kau (盧九), the first “Gambling King”

Given that the public revenues being generated in Macau were at best negligible, the governor of Macau decided to create exclusive rights for activities that were previously controlled by private enterprise. Those activities first included the trading of, respectively, pork meat and beef; opium; and cheap Chinese labor.⁶ Subsequently came rights to operate the Chinese lottery (*Pacapio*⁷), in 1847, and the legalization of fantan houses in 1849.⁸

Soon after the first exclusive fantan license was granted by Governor Ferreira do Amaral in Macau—known as the city of the name of God, proudly extolled as “the centre of the gambling spirits of South China”⁹—the purpose of the legalization had almost-immediate results, reducing the public deficit by the mid-1850s.¹⁰

One year before the legalization, Lou Kau¹¹ was born in Xinhui, Guangdong Province, China, on November 10, 1848, as the third of four brothers. In 1857, he moved with his parents to Macau, where he would spend most of his life, becoming one of the most prominent and influential Chinese merchants of the time and certainly the richest.

In his 20s, he made a fortune in the exclusive pork trade, and enriched himself further¹² with the opium¹³ trade, banking services,¹⁴ and the fantan houses between 1883 and 1905.¹⁵

Before being granted the exclusive fantan license, he founded the Hong Feng Company (宏豐公司) with nine investors from Macau, Guangdong, and Hong Kong.¹⁶ That company already had rights to sell *Pacapio*,¹⁷ a Chinese lottery which still exists in Macau. Later on, in 1881, he established the Yee On Company and acquired the Kung Son Vo Wei Company, the company operating lotteries.¹⁸ Sixteen years later, in 1897, he was awarded with an eight-year monopoly to operate the Vaeseng¹⁹ lottery in Guangdong. At that time, the Guangdong government promised that it would fight illegal operators, a promise that was not fulfilled. In 1900, a very high-ranking Chinese official from the Qing government

[< BACK](#)

was an opponent of gambling, banned the activity and refused to return the fee paid, instead increasing the total due to 4.75 million silver dollars, including interest and missed payments.²⁰ The Hong Feng Company suddenly faced an irreversible crisis. The bet placed by Lou was lost, leaving him bankrupt.

In May of 1888, Lou acquired Portuguese nationality, an unheard-of accomplishment, but 10 years later appeared to have renounced it.²¹

Sun Yat Sen, the father of the Republic of China and its first president, maintained close relations with the Lou family when he arrived in Macau in 1892, at the invitation of Lou Kau to work as a doctor at Macau's Kiang Wu Hospital.²²

Lou, like Stanley Ho and the other moguls, was also a philanthropist. He enriched and gave back to the city. He founded and was a heavy contributor to Kiang Wu Hospital, whose construction he helped finance, and was a board member of the institution. He created free education schools for children from poor families and founded the School of Fishermen's Sons and Brothers.²³ He also created a "relief committee to help victims of disasters in northern China," and in 1895 he was the most generous contributor in the initiative to set up tents for the victims of the plague that swept through Macau.²⁴

His name is also linked with the Tung Sin Tong Charitable Society.²⁵ Founded in 1892, it is the first Chinese charitable organization in Macau, and the most important relief-oriented organization run by the Chinese after Kiang Wu Hospital. Although its incorporation act was signed by 46 individuals, only six—including Lou Kau—signed the request submitted to the governor of Macau.²⁶ He was decorated twice by the King of Portugal for his contributions to Macau society.²⁷ On June 20, 1890, HM Carlos I made him a Knight of the Military Order of Our Lord Jesus Christ,²⁸ and on April 25, 1894, awarded him the Commendation of the Royal Military Order of Our Lady of the Conception in Vila Viçosa.²⁹ In 1898, he received an award from the Chinese Emperor.³⁰

[< BACK](#)

and the houses he resided in being treated as local landmarks. These include the Lou Kau Mansion, a two-storey Cantonese-style courtyard house “featuring the graceful and delicate architectural style in central Guangdong in the late Qing dynasty,”³¹ built in 1889, which is located in downtown Macau. It was bought in the 1960s by the Macau government and is currently a museum. It is also a UNESCO World Heritage site. The other former residence is a house located behind Lou Lim Ieoc Garden, a Suzhou-type garden named after his eldest son, built in 1906 as part of his residence. It was bought in 1973 by the Macau government, opening to the public the following year, and it is one of the most unique retreats in the city.

Lou Kau hung himself from a beam of his house on December 15, 1907, when he was 59. It is said he left behind 10 wives, 17 sons, and 10 daughters.³²

Kou Ho Neng (高可寧), the “Pawnshop King”

Soon after the death of Lou Kau, his family took over the fantan business,³³ with an exclusive license that would last until 1912.

In the Fantan Era, the pricing for exclusive operating rights in Macau was, most of the time, linked with what was happening in public policy next door in Guangdong Province,³⁴ in terms of either permission or prohibition of such gaming.³⁵

After 1912, a new bid was held, with the exclusive operating rights granted to the Chap Seng Cong Si³⁶ company, of which O Loc—also known as O Iek Teng³⁷—was a shareholder. O Loc died in 1913, passing the empire to O Tin Tai. The enterprise had as its manager Kou Ho Neng,³⁸ who would become Macau's second gambling mogul.

[< BACK](#)

China's Guangdong Province. He was later nicknamed the "Pawnshop King" for the many pawnshops he opened successively in Macau and Hong Kong.⁴¹

He was one of the most prominent Chinese business characters in Macau; a philanthropist who was able to get the monopoly of both *fantan*⁴² and of the opium trade.⁴³

Having lost his father, Cou Mao Sang, at the age of five, it is said that Kou started working at the age of 14, playing drums and singing in the streets to survive.⁴⁴ In the 1920s, Kou Ho Neng's empire "sprang from gambling, opium, pawning, banking, grocery, and lotteries, (and) covered almost all of the important industries in Macau at the time."⁴⁵ His fortune made him a powerful Macanese figure in society; he was a director (and in some cases chairman) of the Kiang Wu Hospital, the Tung Sin Tong Charitable Society ("eternal director"⁴⁶ since 1940⁴⁷), the Macau Delegation of the Portuguese Red Cross, and the (still very powerful) Macau Chinese General Chamber of Commerce.⁴⁸

Kou also made incursions into the maritime transportation business, through the Tong On Steamship Company, founded in 1917—the same year he opened the Fu Hang Money Exchange and the Tak Seng On Pawnshop,⁴⁹ the biggest pawnshop in the city, located in the vicinity of the gambling houses.⁵⁰

It was an eight-story warehouse full of gold, jewelry, and precious stones—built with granite foundations, thick brick walls, and steel plates—capable of withstanding fire, flooding, and theft.⁵¹ It remained in operation until 1993. The building was sold to the Macau government in 2000, restored, and opened in 2003 as the Pawnshop Museum. It received, in September of 2004, an Honorable Mention in the UNESCO 2004 Asia-Pacific Awards for the Conservation of Cultural Heritage.

[< BACK](#)

the role of “a bank for the poor and a place for the rich to store their valuables.”⁵³ Working in a pawn shop was a desirable and lifelong job, accessible only to those who came well recommended. Chinese were superstitious about pawnshops: children were allowed in and could walk around, enabling the shop to rub off on them and give them health and riches in the future.⁵⁴

Kou Hou Neng's chain of pawnshops worked as a de facto monopoly of the pawnshop business, a synergetic activity to casinos and a greatly lucrative business.⁵⁵ In the 1950s there were about 30 pawnshops that advertised “24 hours service [where the] redeemed items could be bought back in Hong Kong and Kowloon,”⁵⁶ as most of the customers came from Hong Kong⁵⁷ to gamble in Macau.

During Kou's life, Macau was an opium distribution and selling point in the Far East. The production, processing, and consumption were legal in Macau, where factories to process the paste to produce opium were located. The taxes levied on the opium trade were an important source of revenue for the Macau government (in its peak they represented one-third of total government revenues⁵⁸). To run the opium business, Kou Ho Neng undertook a joint venture on August 1, 1913, with nine of his friends⁵⁹—called “Hall of Ten Friends”⁶⁰—and obtained a five-year opium monopoly license on behalf of the Iau Seng Company.

However, it is in the gambling business that Kou became renowned. He was linked to the operation of fantan, initially through the Tak Seng Company, of which he was a partner. In 1911, he won the bid to operate fantan houses⁶¹ and established one at Rua da Caldeira. In 1918, he operated the Daxin Pupiao Company as well. Pupiao (鋪票) was a very popular lottery at the time. In 1920, he founded the Fu Yuan Lottery Company.⁶²

To increase tax revenues and develop the economy of Macau, in 1930 the Macau government granted the first gambling concession, in the form of a monopoly, to Iun Iun Company, the first to operate all types of games of chance permitted

[< BACK](#)

Hotel Central was the first gambling destination with other attractions, and the establishment was intricately related to gambling since 1930. Inaugurated by the governor of Macau, Tamagnini Barbosa, on July 22, 1928, as “Presidente Hotel,”⁶³ it was remodeled, renovated, and renamed the “Grand Hotel Central” on October 31, 1930.⁶⁴ The luxurious, classic lines of the casino combined with cutting-edge management, where all types of approved casino games—including fantan, cussec, and p'ai kao—could be offered, attracting gamblers from Hong Kong and mainland China. In addition to gambling, the gamblers enjoyed free cigarettes, fruit, food, and Chinese opera shows.⁶⁵

Due to internal problems, Iun Iun entered into “huge financial crisis and deep debts,”⁶⁶ making it impossible to pay the gaming tax (even after it was adjusted to 600,000 patacas per annum). It was in this scenario that, in 1937, Tai Heng Company⁶⁷ was established, with Fu Tak Iam as the dominant shareholder, with 63.8% of the share capital. Kou Ho Neng was only indirectly a shareholder in Tai Heng, through his son Kou Fok Meng.⁶⁸ The company secured the monopoly of gaming operations in Macau with a carefully designed policy that excluded potential bidders,⁶⁹ at a bidding price of 1.826 million patacas per annum, managing to keep the monopoly for 24 years, 7 months, and 13 days (May 18, 1937 to December 31, 1961). This lengthy period was made possible through three consecutive three-year contracts (1937–1946), followed by seven consecutive two-year contracts (1946–1961).

Hotel Central was bought by Kou Ho Neng and Fu Tak Iam and re-inaugurated on May 18, 1937, under the name of “Hotel Central.” Though “[h]istorical references to the hotel depict a colorful and sometimes sinister side, with spies walking its hallways (and gambling), gangsters and occasional bomb attacks,”⁷⁰ Hotel Central was one of Macau's most luxurious ventures at the time. Its dancing halls, cabaret shows, two-story casino, lavish rooms, and elevators were “highly frequented by rich men from Hong Kong and Mainland China during the Second Sino-Japanese War between Japan and China (1937–1945).”⁷¹ Nevertheless, it was the target of low-powered petards (small bombs), which resulted in minor

[< BACK](#)

relatively common, prompting authorities to propose and take preventive measures.⁷² Although it offered the traditional Chinese games, such as fantan, p'ai kao, and cussec, it is wrongly⁷³ said that it was the Tai Heng Company that introduced Western games, such as baccarat (the most popular casino game to this day) and blackjack.⁷⁴

Featured in several cinema movies in the 1940s and 1950s, such as *Macao*—starring Jane Russel and Robert Mitchum—and the place where (to mention just a few) Clark Gable, William Holden, and Ian Fleming stayed while in Macau, Hotel Central is located on Avenida de Almeida Ribeiro, in Macau's main commercial district. The building, six stories tall at the time of its construction, was Macau's first ever high-rise. It is also the first building in Macau with elevators. Five extra floors were added in 1942. There were casinos on the fifth and seventh floors of the building.

Hotel rooms, a bar and restaurants, live concerts and nightclubs, shops, and gambling facilities were all concentrated under the same roof. A noted feature of the hotel's gaming floor was the small reed baskets sent down by cord from the “balconies which surround the gambling hell,” balconies which “collected the members of the Chinese *haute monde*, mandarins and other functionaries, who can join in the game unperceived by the common herd below,”⁷⁵ who, using the baskets, whisked their bets to the croupier.

About Hotel Central, Ian Fleming wrote:⁷⁶

“[t]he Central Hotel is not precisely a hotel. It is a nine-storey skyscraper, by far the largest building in Macao, and it is devoted solely to the human so-called vices. It has one more original feature. The higher up the building you go, the more beautiful and expensive are the girls, the higher the stakes at the gambling tables, and the better the music. Thus, on the ground floor, the honest coolie can choose a girl of his own class and gamble for pennies by lowering his bet on a fishing-rod contraption through a hole in the floor on to the gaming tables

[< BACK](#)

paradise on the sixth floor. Above this are the bedrooms.”⁷⁷

However, the poor management of Tai Heng Company, and the absence of enthusiasm for the gambling industry by the heirs of Kou Ho Neng and Fu Tak Iam, led the Macau government to once again redesign the sector, ending the decades-long monopoly.

In 1951, Kou Ho Neng was also involved in the wine business in Hong Kong, through Tak Chuen Distillery (德泉酒庄), a producer and distributor of a variety of Chinese wines.⁷⁸

The idea of giving back to society was an ever-present concern during Kou Hou Neng's life. He was enthusiastic about public welfare undertakings, making substantial charitable contributions to organizations in Macau,⁷⁹ being a regular donor to Kiang Wu Hospital, Tung Sin Tong Charitable Society,⁸⁰ and the Macau Delegation of the Portuguese Red Cross.⁸¹ In 1924, Kou and Li Ji Tang underwrote Tung Sin Tong's project to open a free school and passed on the operational rights after the school was on the right track. “They donated thousands of dollars for setting up an operating fund and building the new campus. There was no possibility of establishing the school without their help.”⁸² The same year, Kou donated 5,000 patacas for the construction of a new, 43,000-pataca⁸³ building housing Tung Sin Tong's headquarters. In 1941, he initiated the establishment of the Tung Sin Tong Pharmacy and, aside from a contribution of 10,000 patacas⁸⁴ (out of the 50,000 needed),⁸⁵ he donated his private property as the pharmacy site.⁸⁶

In March of 1942, for example, he (along with Fu Tak Iam) contributed one-tenth of the 5 million patacas needed by the Macau government to send 50,000 refugees back to their homelands. During World War II, for an extensive period, he financed the distribution of soup to the poor.

[< BACK](#)

Cross Society.⁸⁷ On November 29, 1928, according to a resolution by the Macau Holy House of Mercy's Table of Directors, he was considered a Meritorious [Member] of the Fraternity of the Macau Holy House of Mercy.⁸⁸ He was also decorated as a Commander of the Order of Benevolence⁸⁹ by the president of the Republic of Portugal, Óscar Carmona, and as a Commander of the Military Order of Christ by the president of the Republic of Portugal, Craveiro Lopes, on June 27, 1952.⁹⁰

The name of Kou Ho Neng is also associated with the story of the “Dog-Man,” a feared and famous pirate chief. It is said⁹¹ that Kou Ho Neng's brother, Kou Leong Tai, was kidnapped by pirates during a trip to Guangdong. He asked the pirates to deliver a letter to his brother, in which he asked him to pay the requested ransom for his release. Kou Ho Neng, who hated his brother, not only did not pay the ransom but also paid the pirates to keep his brother in captivity. Kou Leong Tai was incarcerated in a tiny bamboo cage for 14 years, where he could only squat. After being released, unable to stretch his legs again, he moved while supporting himself on his hands and feet, like a dog. “Destroying his brother in the seemingly inviolable refuge of Macau, more than looting, was the main objective of his actions, dedicating himself to him with frustrating tenacity until the end of his days.”⁹²

His presence is still felt in Macau, be it the road on the Macau peninsula named after him⁹³—“Rua do Comendador Kou Hó Neng”⁹⁴—located in the exquisite Penha Hill district;⁹⁵ the house he bought⁹⁶ to live in in 1916⁹⁷—the “Kou Ho Neng Mansion”⁹⁸—a Portuguese colonial era yellow mansion located on the Macau peninsula at Rua do Campo; the Pawnshop Museum in the Seng On Pawnshop building, located in downtown Macau at Avenida de Almeida Ribeiro; or his bronze bust in the courtyard of the centenary Macau Tung Sin Tong Charitable Society, erected as a token of appreciation for the large contributions he made. In Hong Kong, he also has a school named after him.⁹⁹

[< BACK](#)

left behind “some 16 sons and 24 daughters, as well as numerous other descendants.”¹⁰²

Fu Tak lam (傅德蔭), the “Chinese Capitalist”

Known as the “Chinese Capitalist,” Fu Tak lam¹⁰³ was born in the 21st year of the Qing dynasty's Guangxu reign, on March 15, 1895,¹⁰⁴ in Xiqiao Town, Nanhai District, Foshan City, Guangdong Province, to a poor farming family.¹⁰⁵

The second of four sons, he was raised by his mother in poverty. His father, Fu Yangfang, was forced to leave Nanhai to make a living in Hong Kong to support the family.

Fu never received a formal education.¹⁰⁶ He made the journey to Hong Kong in 1912, to help his father in a metal shop. In 1914, he took a job at Siu On Shipping Company as a stoker in the boiler room of a British vessel, working a route between Hong Kong, Macau, Guangzhou, and ports along the Pearl River Delta. When working in Hong Kong, he often came to Macau to try his luck in the casino. People in gambling circles were so familiar with him that they called him “Lao Yong.”¹⁰⁷

Although his fortune derives from the trade of opium, it was the operation of gambling that brought him fame.¹⁰⁸ Fu was already in the gambling business before having a stake in Macau's gambling market. By the end of the 1920s, he got into a fight which led to his imprisonment for 10 months. After serving out his sentence, Fu returned to Guangdong, where he started his first pawnshop business¹⁰⁹ and, in collaboration with Huo Zhiting—the holder of the opium and gambling franchise for the entire Guangdong province, opened “gambling houses chiefly devoted to Fan-Tan in Guangzhou and nearby cities and towns.”¹¹⁰ Allegedly a powerful character in the secret societies of Guangdong (“bodyguard to warlords in the Canton area in his wayward formative years”),¹¹¹ Macau, and Hong Kong, he operated underground casinos in Shenzhen, China.¹¹²

[< BACK](#)

reputedly shared Sherlock Holmes' weakness for indoor pistol practice at the family residence. According to one story, perhaps apocryphal, he had the hearty habit, in his middle years, when the port was being passed after the ladies had retired, of firing a revolver under the table "to see who was the lucky man." In his mellowing years, he disclaimed this story with a thin smile, but it is seriously reported that two of his retainers on the pension list had wooden legs.¹¹³

In 1937, the Nationalist government in China banned gambling on the mainland. The casino in Shenzhen closed and Fu returned to Macau to make a second attempt at the franchise in the city. Not successful in the 1930 bid for the gaming monopoly, he joined ranks in 1937 with Kou Ho Neng, under the umbrella of the Tai Heng Company, and successfully bid for the gaming monopoly, starting January of 1937. According to one of his grandsons, he "stayed up until all the cash from the casinos had been collected and safely stored."¹¹⁴

In February of 1946, Fu was kidnapped at the pavilions behind Kun Iam Temple,¹¹⁵ where he used to go for a pipe or two of opium with the abbot, and held for ransom.¹¹⁶ After reporting the kidnapping to the police, the kidnappers sent the family part of Fu's ear to show that they meant business (the same happened in 1953 when one of his sons was kidnapped).¹¹⁷ The highly influential Chinese businessman Ho Hin was asked by the family "to act as a middleman to plead for his friend" and went¹¹⁸ to Hong Kong to hand over the HKD 900,000 ransom to the kidnappers.¹¹⁹

To diversify his investment risk, Fu had interests in passenger ships, through Tai Sang Ferry Company, operating between Hong Kong and Macau, and later through Tak Kee Shipping and Trading Co., which expanded into passenger and cargo services in the greater Guangdong–Hong Kong–Macau area. He also invested in the redevelopment of

[< BACK](#)

Tai Fung Money Changer,¹²⁰ which later evolved into Tai Fung Bank, an institution that still operates in Macau.

As most Chinese, Fu was superstitious, namely, “of the colour red being unlucky, and of green and white favouring the casino,” and as such “red was banned from gambling rooms.”¹²¹ The Hotel Central casino employees wore green and white uniforms.

As almost all influential Chinese in Macau, Fu was also recognized by the Portuguese authorities, being decorated a Commander of the Military Order of Christ by the president of the Republic of Portugal, Craveiro Lopes, on June 27, 1952.¹²²

In 2017, Fu Tak lam's family created the Fu Tak Yung Foundation, which aims to develop the areas of education, culture, health, and technological research, and other activities of a social and charitable nature.¹²³ His name is also associated with the house he owned at the very tip of Barra, down from the Penha Hill, at 28–34 Avenida da República, which is still in the family estate.

Fu Tak lam died at the age of 65, on November 16, 1960, at the Hong Kong Sanatorium and Hospital. He is buried alongside his four wives at Hong Kong's Aberdeen Chinese Permanent Cemetery. He left behind 15 children.

These individuals were the most important predecessors of Stanley Ho, who helped to create the business for which Stanley and his partners presented a bid for the exclusive concession in 1961. Common among them were the various businesses in which they were involved and their philanthropic nature, with an altruistic approach to corporate responsibility.

Stanley followed in their footsteps, innovated and improved the industry which was then built up to achieve international recognition. The process was not easy, but when the 24 bidders submitted proposals for the international public tender

[< BACK](#)

the immense success of all the operators since 2002, totally changing and influencing other jurisdictions. Given that Macau has become the world's top casino gambling destination and if “it's going continue to be one of the most interesting stories in gambling for years to come,”¹²⁴ we should credit what was achieved by Stanley Ho before 2002.

STANLEY'S EURASIAN DUTCH ROOTS

In June of 1598, five ships lay ready to depart from the port of Rotterdam,¹²⁵ to set sail for Asia for the first time. By that time, the Portuguese had been doing business with China for nearly 90 years, and had established a settlement in Macau for about 40 years.

In 1513, Captain Jorge Álvares set foot on Chinese soil—just miles from where Stanley Ho, the grandson of Ho Fook and great grandson of the Dutch Comprador¹²⁶ Charles Henri Maurice Bosman and Sze Sze, would make his fortune in casinos—which would see the establishment of the Portuguese settlement and the entry into the so-called mixed jurisdiction period,¹²⁷ one which was to last until 1849 (the date on which the first fantan houses were legalized).

The original idea for the Dutch ship, at least in the minds of the sailors, was to reach the Moluccas to buy spices, and explore the silver route of Japan.¹²⁸ Once they were on the high seas, heavily laden with weaponry, the real mission was revealed: to raid and plunder the Portuguese and Spanish, the two great powers of the day, in South America and Asia.¹²⁹

Only one of the ships arrived in Japan: *Liefde* (“Charity” or “Love”). One returned to Rotterdam, one was lost to the Portuguese, another was lost to the Spanish, and the last to the Tempest.¹³⁰

[< BACK](#)

(VOC), realized the importance of direct trade with China.¹³¹ In 1624, the Dutch established a “fortified settlement” on the island of Formosa and, after being threatened, VOC endeavored through diplomacy to obtain what were then called trading privileges.¹³²

The first VOC embassy of 1655–1657 was a failure, wiping out Dutch commercial success in maritime Asia, with the rise of the Zheng family's Chinese trading empire.¹³³

About two centuries after the failure of the VOC's embassy, and once the Dutch had dominated maritime commerce in Asia, Comprador Bosman came to Hong Kong, at the age of 20, to work for coolie merchant Cornelius Koopmanschap,¹³⁴ a Dutch labor broker who was in the business of importing and exporting cheap Chinese labor. In the 1860s, Koopmanschap lived between California and Hong Kong, and with his connections he was considered the main contractor and importer of Chinese labor to San Francisco.¹³⁵

The skills of the 24-year-old Charles Bosman, along with the fact that Cornelius needed to focus on the thriving U.S. market—the Central Pacific Railroad needed a lot of cheap labor—and spend more time in California, are most likely key reasons for the transformation of the firm in Hong Kong into Bosman & Co, with the U.S. unit operating under the name Koopmanschap & Co shortly after Mr. Bosman became Dutch Consul, a tenure that allowed him to control and oversee the shipping of labor to Dutch Guiana, in South America.

On February 19, 1863, an act was passed prohibiting the “Coolie Trade” by American Citizens in American Vessels.¹³⁶ The coolie trade was banned, as it was considered a form of slavery, which in itself may have had a significant impact on the business of Mr. Bosman, who moved from Hong Kong to London in the late 1860s or early 1870s, where he established the “Eastern Agency” in 1873.

[< BACK](#)

Fook Ho, born in 1863, the grandfather of Stanley Ho and brother of Sir Robert Hotung, one of Macau's greatest philanthropists. Wai Fook Ho had 13 children, one of them the father of Stanley Ho, Ho Sai-kwong (何世光). The Ho clan was wealthy and influential in the colonial Hong Kong period of the late nineteenth century and the first quarter of the twentieth century. Stanley's grandfather was no different in his position as Chief Compradore at Jardine, Matheson & Co.,¹³⁷ an original trading house that dates back to Imperial China and is still a Hong Kong conglomerate. He also had the crucial role of leader of the Chinese community.

Ho Sai-kwong married Flora Sinn and had five children, including Stanley Ho Hung-sun, who was born on November 25, 1921. The day after, the newspaper headline of the Hong Kong English *China Mail* included a dispatch from London from the previous day about the speech Chao Hsin Chu, China's *chargé d'affaires* in London at the time, had made to students. In the speech the official declared that: "stability would ultimately be established in both cases and urged the students to make English friends realize that China was philosophically and spiritually civilized, and contradict rumors that China was incapable of solving her troubles without outside interference."¹³⁸

Later in Stanley's life, making foreign friends was a highway to his enormous success.

The financial crisis of 1929 had a massive impact on Stanley's life, wiping out Ho Sai-kwong's fortune. Two of Stanley Ho's siblings were driven to suicide and he was left, at the age of 13, to care for his mother and two other sisters.

KING'S EDUCATION AT QUEEN'S COLLEGE, WAR REFUGEE BECOMES MILLIONAIRE IN MACAU

As a result of the First Opium War, which ended in 1842, China had to open its ports. Hong Kong had been occupied by the British since 1841. Twenty-one years after that, in 1862, an Anglo-Chinese secondary school was established by the

[< BACK](#)

China and to strengthen the youth of the country.”¹³⁹ The school was located on Gough Street, Sheung Wan. The need for more space prompted the school to move to Aberdeen Street and Hollywood Road in 1884, along with the name change to Victoria College (維多利亞書院). In 1894, the school was renamed Queen's College, a bilingual school where Chinese and Western subjects were taught.¹⁴⁰

At this school, young Stanley unsuccessfully attended Grade D, which was then the lowest grade-level in Hong Kong's Class System. Despite his initial failure, the ninth child of his family received a university scholarship to the University Hong Kong.¹⁴¹ “By 4th grade, it was bad, I almost did not make it to the next grade,” Stanley later stated, “[t]hey said, Stanley Ho, even if we put you in this class, it wouldn't be enough.”

Suddenly the wealthy and influential Ho family went bankrupt. Stanley later revealed:¹⁴²

[o]ne night my mother cried and said she had no money to send me on to school. I was thirteen and asked her: we were rich, how could this happen? She replied: the business went down the drain and all the stocks your father bought became worthless. Your father took your oldest brothers to Sai Kung and we have no money left. There will be no shortage of food at the table, but there probably won't be enough for an education.

That moment changed teenage Stanley's life. In his words: “[t]hat night I was up all-night thinking that the situation wasn't so bad and if I worked hard enough I could improve the situation, and I strived to be the best student I could be. Then, one semester, they announced ‘Stanley Ho, in first place, and the crowd went wild!’ With that, I was able to get the scholarship to the university.”¹⁴³

[< BACK](#)

I am grateful that I was poor then, because when you are poor you can see things clearly. When my family members saw our relatives, they discriminated against them, which proves how money can change people.”¹⁴⁴

With the scholarship, Stanley went on to study chemistry and biology at the Hong Kong University. A Class D student at Queen's College, he became the top student in his class at university. In his words, “[i]n my second year at Hong Kong University, the professors loved me. Firstly, because I was the only one who came from Hong Kong and could pass in an attempt. Everything I didn't know, they taught me. I was the student who loved to write tests, whenever I got any kind of test, I would write for an hour and a half non-stop and submit it early to get first place once again.”¹⁴⁵

On December 18, 1941, while he was finishing his degree at the university, Japanese troops invaded Hong Kong and seized the city's main reservoirs, prompting the British to surrender by Christmas Day.¹⁴⁶ Streets changed names, and what is now Connaught Road was renamed Nakasumiyoshi-dori until the end of the war.¹⁴⁷

Soon after the British capitulation, Stanley went to Macau, where he began to work as secretary of the Cooperative Company of Macau (*Cooperativa*),¹⁴⁸ a company whose share capital was divided between the local government, wealthy Chinese entrepreneurs,¹⁴⁹ and the Japanese military. Portugal was neutral during World War II (or the Pacific War) and, consequently, Macau Province had the same status. Stanley had begun to learn Japanese and Portuguese, which would make him an important asset to the company. Shortages of food and other essential goods forced the Macau government, represented by Pedro Lobo, to nationalize all essential goods. The neutral status made Macau a natural destination for refugees.

Two decades earlier, it was also the destination for people fleeing the Guangzhou trade wars. The population doubled from about 74,000 in 1910 to about 193,000 in 1924,¹⁵⁰ with numbers declining until 1936, when the Sino-Japanese war began. In 1940, the population of Macau was about 375,000.¹⁵¹ The increase in population caused by the wars, together

[< BACK](#)

Era.”

The Era, along with the Chinese characters for crisis (危機 Wéijī—danger and opportunity), was the perfect stage for Sir Robert Hotung's great-nephew to thrive and fulfil the promise he made to his weeping mother when his ruined father abandoned her and fled to Vietnam: he would devote himself to his studies, make a fortune, and return comfort to the family.¹⁵²

Two days after his arrival in Macau, Stanley went with his great uncle to the Governor's House on a mission that lasted three years and eight months: he was tasked with teaching English to the head of Japanese Intelligence, Colonel Sawa.¹⁵³

As with his great grandfather Charles Bosman, Stanley's skills as a secretary in *Cooperativa*, which included the fact that he could speak Japanese, led the other partners to offer him a position as a partner in the vital goods monopoly. It was the first time Stanley had partnered with a government. The *Cooperativa* monopoly, like other monopolies throughout history, and in various sectors of the economy, fostered parallel economies. The same thing happened in Macau with the Triad Siu Keng Siu (“*O Imortal*”) along with other local entrepreneurs who smuggled vital goods into the refugee area.¹⁵⁴

Although the social crisis was obvious, the fact is that the neutrality status allowed businesses to flourish. The refugees included wealthy or educated people who were crucial to Macau's economic revival.¹⁵⁵ Trade in gold began to play an important role. Former Hong Kong gold and silver traders opened shops in Macau,¹⁵⁶ and turned the enclave into the “Far East Gold City.” As the population grew, hotels and restaurants followed, as well as gambling dens, opium and prostitution parlors, and smuggling.¹⁵⁷

[< BACK](#)

turned 20, when the firm gave him a bonus of 1 million Hong Kong dollars for joining the *Cooperativa* as a partner.¹⁵⁸

THE FAILED GOLD CONCESSION BECOMES THE SUCCESSFUL GAMBLING CONCESSION

Despite its neutrality during the war, Macau woke on the morning of January 15, 1945, “to the routine noise of American planes, but this time the bombers' mission was not the Japanese-occupied Chinese cities, but Macau itself.”¹⁵⁹ The target was fuel stored in the city's warehouses, to be sold to the Japanese, and a smuggling operation the Dutch navy suspected of being in the service of the Japanese.¹⁶⁰ Whether the *Cooperativa's* activities included those of the American targets is not known.

If the Pacific War was initially dangerous, and opened up opportunities for Stanley, the end of the war was a defining moment for his validation as an entrepreneur.

In the aftermath of the conflict, the collaboration of Macau's local forces with the defeated Japanese claimed its political victims. On August 4, 1946, Governor Gabriel Maurício Teixeira was replaced for 13 months by a *charge d'affaires*, Samuel Conceição Vieira, then-commander of the vessel “Afonso de Albuquerque.” The reason for the replacement was a request by the Chinese authorities, who accused the government of the time of collaboration with the Japanese.¹⁶¹ Soon after, in November of 1946, under pressure from China, the opium trade was stopped with a moratorium until June 30, 1947, to “rehabilitate the addicts.”¹⁶²

The end of the legalized opium trade did not have much effect on Macau's financial resources, as the Chinese gold trade was already playing an important role, despite the lack of regulation¹⁶³ that was to come into effect by that time. A license was required, and the Economic Services began to control the business.¹⁶⁴ Macau's role in the gold business would continue until January of 1974, when the gold market was officially opened in Hong Kong.¹⁶⁵

[< BACK](#)

crucial role in licensing the business.

Stanley—one of the two members of the Ho clan in Macau at the time who helped shape postwar Macau, along with his great uncle Sir Robert Hotung (from whom he learned how to be successful in a closed society)—married Clementina Ângela de Melo Leitão in 1946, a Macanese daughter of Carlos Ernesto Melo Leitão, the only licensed public notary at the time in Macau. In parallel, Notary Leitão was also active in the hospitality industry, and possibly involved in the casino business, operated by the concessionaire Tai Heng since the late 1930s.

Stanley's engagement to the first of his four wives gave him access to what can be called the “jet set” of Macau, as he was able to obtain vital information for his thriving trading business. With the Chinese Communist Revolution and with the outbreak of the Korean War, Stanley Ho saw his fortunes rise, especially after the U.S. embargo on China under the United Nations resolutions of May 1951.

His business model¹⁶⁷ was to use import licenses that would legitimize cargo from Hong Kong ships and, instead of sending goods to Dili, East Timor, change their final destination to the People's Republic of China.¹⁶⁸ According to Stanley, in a February 2007 interview with *Macau Closer* magazine:¹⁶⁹

A few years later I was running the blockade imposed on China after the Korean War started. I was doing it legally as I had an import license from the Macau Government. But then the Americans came to me, saying that I had violated the embargo on China, and from then on I was not allowed to import refrigerators, air-conditioners and many other things, which was very inconvenient for me. You know, I later submitted a proposal for the gaming monopoly in Macau. At that time, someone tried to lobby the Portuguese government not to give the licen[s]e to me on reasons that I was not on friendly terms with the Chinese. This was just the

[< BACK](#)

Lisbon whether the Chinese were my friends or my enemies. And the reply was “Stanley Ho has been running the blockade for several years. So he and the Chinese should be very close friends.” And of course, this finally helped clear the whole issue.

Friendship again, a motto ever-present in his business career.

If the U.S. embargo against China in the early 1950s allowed the business of Stanley Ho's trading agency—*Agência Comercial Progresso*—to flourish, the fact is that the U.S. Department of Commerce revoked all licensing privileges and denied export licenses¹⁷⁰ in 1959. This incident, and the alleged links with the Triads, which were never proven, made him persona non grata in the U.S., a designation which, with some exceptions (such as during the Clinton administration), was to haunt him until his death.

As a businessman, Stanley had to find new ways to profit and turned to the gold business, which was under an exclusive contract in the hands of the concessionaire Wong On Company. Jorge Godinho mentions that political—alignment with the interests of the People's Republic of China—and economic reasons were behind Stanley's failure to obtain the exclusive contract.¹⁷¹

From 1926 to 1974, Macau operated under the shroud of the dictatorship era in Portugal, and the message in official speeches at that time was consistent with an abolitionist view of gambling,¹⁷² although concrete steps in that direction were never taken.

By the late 1950s, Macau was in full recovery from the wartime ravages. As many of the refugees left the territory,¹⁷³ the population dropped significantly.

[< BACK](#)

dated November 8, 1960 to the Portuguese Overseas Minister, the governor made an x-ray of the gambling industry at the time,¹⁷⁴ including the need to clean up the underground elements within the industry, operate the games in clean and proper premises, address the problem of gambling—restrict roulette games to foreign players—and ensure diversification of the gambling clientele, generate revenue to combat drug use and prostitution, and bring revenue to the Province. A new bid for the exclusive concession was then proposed. With his conjugal access to the restricted clique of power, Stanley Ho should have known exactly what the governor intended.

As referred to above, Tai Heng had been operating the fantan houses since 1937, during which time there were no major developments in the industry. The government was content to merely receive the rent and let the monopolies continue, making monopolists and the government lazy. Tai Heng had sent a letter to the government before 1960 seeking permission to operate roulette. But the fact is that the status quo would be maintained.

In his 40s, Stanley Ho and his partners wanted to change the situation, and the bidding was perfect for their intentions. In the other camp, Tai Heng may not have taken the competition seriously.¹⁷⁵ Stanley Ho liked challenges. Speaking directly of the topic he said: “I have got this franchise because it was a challenge for me, because I cannot understand why only 40 miles apart, Hong Kong was so prosperous, and Macau was a dying city. So again, I love challenges, I put in a bid and I won the concession.”¹⁷⁶

Things were not as simple as Stanley stated in this interview. When he won, with a bid of MOP 3,167,000,¹⁷⁷ turbulent times began, and Governor Silvério Marques was subsequently fired. Stanley Ho, in a Hollywood-worthy script, portrays the threats of Y.C. Leung, the powerful owner of the gold deal concessionaire, as follows:¹⁷⁸

Y.C. Leung sent me several threats just before we started to operate the monopoly.

[< BACK](#)

Number 2: “No person in Macau will dare to lease you any place for opening a casino.”

Number 3: “No one will be helping you. (Former operators) Kou and Fu will continue to pay their staff.”

Number 4: “I’ll arrange 200 baggers to surround your casino, so no one will dare to go in.”

Number 5: “All the ferries will stop running, and you’ll not be able to bring your customers to Macau.”

I ignored all the threats because after accepting the license I had to open, otherwise I would lose face. I just promised I would not touch his gold business.

On January 1st, 1962 I opened the casino at 12 o’clock, and the Governor appeared 5 minutes later. The place was almost empty and there were almost no Chinese in there—they’ve all boycotted on instructions of Y.C. Leung.

I still remember what I said at the opening. It was reported in the South China Morning Post. I said, “The view that our enterprise is merely one of a gambling character is really a misunderstanding and even a misconception. The unified purpose is to develop tourism and the entertainment business in order to achieve a new prosperity for Macau, and as a means to bring about the improvement of the welfare and living standard of the citizens of Macau.” History proves that I did keep my promise.

These incidents are also well documented in a 2004 interview of Stanley Ho,¹⁷⁹ in which he revealed some details about the previous concessionaire’s efforts to prevent him from operating.

[< BACK](#)

minutes after midnight and congratulated Stanley on the inauguration. Shortly afterwards, he drew Stanley into a corner and showed him a telegram from the Portuguese Overseas Minister which stated: "Hold all [gaming] operations until further notice." The governor then said to Stanley Ho: "Mr. Stanley Ho, I never received this telegram," and tore the telegram to pieces.¹⁸⁰ This was confirmed by the governor's wife, who said about the incident¹⁸¹ that the governor received a telegram with these contents at about 7:00 p.m. on December 31, 1962. The governor asked his assistant to put the telegram in a drawer and told him: "This telegram will not be received until tomorrow!"

All that was promised by Stanley Ho seems to have been accomplished. In an interview with the Portuguese local broadcaster TDM, he said of his application and his promises to win the 1961 bid: "I promised the moon and I have fulfilled all my promises."¹⁸²

The fulfilment of the promises was possible primarily because of his outstanding business acumen, his knowledge of the city and its dynamism, but certainly also because he had good partners with financial capacity: Henry Fok, Teddy Yip and Yip Hon,¹⁸³ all founders of the STDM, the company to which Stanley transferred the concession rights under the contract signed in Lisbon on March 31, 1962, exactly 40 years before the end of the so-called STDM Era, in 2002. The concession was initially granted *intuitu personae*¹⁸⁴ which could lead to the conclusion that Stanley and his partners did not believe they would win the tender, considering the other competitor.

From 1962 to 2002, gaming in Macau was conducted under a monopoly system operated by STDM. Over the years, STDM had a stake in all the major infrastructure projects, as well as in the share capital of the electricity company, the airport, the flag carrier, the jetfoil carrier, and the helicopter service, being part of the obligations under the concession contract that related to investment and development.¹⁸⁵ In this context, the last governor of Macau, General Rocha Vieira, describes Stanley Ho as an ally of the Macau government, respectful of power, and always ready to cooperate in

[< BACK](#)

common to hear the slogan allegedly attributed to Stanley: “what is good for STDM is good for Macau.”¹⁸⁷

The first decade of the concession was marked by the crisis of December 3, 1966,¹⁸⁸ brought about by tensions between the local government and the Chinese community, largely caused by the Chinese Cultural Revolution. Gambling operations were suspended for a short period of time, and certainly Mr. Ho was concerned about the future when the Red Guards began demonstrations against the presence of the Portuguese in Macau.¹⁸⁹

But things resumed as expected and, on February 3, 1970, the iconic Hotel Lisboa was finally opened to the public. In the 1962 concession agreement, STDM's obligations included building a state-of-the-art casino, constructing a luxury hotel, and paying a fixed rent.

The man who asserted that he had never gambled in his life could focus on other contractual obligations after this milestone. The future gambling mecca was developing in the context of expanding worldwide tourism, and the popularization of air travel, as well as a time of peace—or at least of wars that were not global.¹⁹⁰

The Carnation Revolution in Portugal came on April 25, 1974. Five months after arriving in Macau, Governor Garcia Leandro had a well-documented dispute with Stanley Ho's STDM, when one of the revisions to the gambling concession contract was pending. Governor Leandro had always believed that STDM was not paying enough to, at that time, the officially renamed Territory of Macau. Among other things, he proposed that STDM should pay 120 million patacas, instead of the 9 million stipulated under the contract in effect. Stanley Ho and his partners were shocked, and asked ironically if it was a typo—with an extra zero in the amount.¹⁹¹

Believe it or not, it was after this contract change that STDM began to grow even more, with the introduction of baccarat and “dead chips.” The example given by Stanley Ho in Portuguese, during the traditional speech of STDM's annual

[< BACK](#)

Macau government. Stanley Ho began with the words “[i]t is a weakness to be a tiger among lambs,” but added, certainly with direct aim, “[n]ever fight with a government official: a tiger does not kill a tiger.”¹⁹²

A concession is defined as an administrative law contract between (usually) a state and a private company to operate certain essential public services and public utilities. The model was introduced in Portugal to regulate the relationship between Portugal and gambling concessionaires in 1927. The idea is that concessionaires are extensions of the government, which, for various reasons, does not want (or does not have the expertise) to operate a certain business. In the case of gambling, it is an absolute reserve of the state, meaning it is a prohibited activity unless the government grants rights to it. The similarities with the Nevada model set forth in Nevada Revised Statutes § 463 (Gaming Control Act) is that the concession, which is not a license, is a “revocable privilege.” Stanley Ho knew full-well the nature of the concession and also understood that fighting a tiger would not be beneficial to his business interests.

Jorge Neto Valente, a prominent lawyer who has been in Macau since the 1970s, testified the following about Stanley Ho's attitude towards the political turmoil that took place in the early 1980s, with the dissolution of Legislative Assembly in Macau by Governor Almeida e Costa, in a documentary aired by TDM on May 26, 2020:¹⁹³

Jorge Neto Valente: “Stanley, you should not support the Governor in these matters. You should consider that the Governor goes and the Macanese community stays.”

Stanley Ho: “I understand that very well but, regarding my activity, one thing should not be up for debate: my policy must be the policy of the Governor in office!”

[< BACK](#)

Macau' Managing Director, described Stanley Ho as an excellent person, who was always willing to help when he knew his associates were in trouble. Stanley Ho is also described as a very humble and considerate public figure towards the media, understanding their role and reasoning that: "they are doing their job, and I must respect that." His philanthropic nature was remarkable and "[f]or over 40 years, STDM was virtually the only local Maecenas, the door where most people with cultural and charitable projects knocked and asked for support and never left empty-handed."¹⁹⁴ The impact of his actions and contributions are well described by Christina Miu Bing Cheng:¹⁹⁵

His [Stanley Ho's] charitable contributions even won papal approval. The Pope in the Vatican City conferred on him the Papal Insignia of "Knight Commander of the Equestrian Order of Saint Gregory the Great" in 1989 in appreciation and recognition of the "magnanimity and humanitarian gestures of the Macau and Hong Kong Impresario towards the Catholic Church." The Pope's ecclesiastical endorsement, however, only blurs the boundary between churches and casinos, and financial contributions may enhance one's chances of papal recognition.

UNDESIRABLE LINKS AND U.S. COMPETITION

The name Stanley Ho has been under scrutiny by foreign government agencies since the 1950s, particularly the U.S. and Australia. If, in the first case, it was because of his trading activities, in the second it was his alleged links with Chinese Triads.

In 1988, Stanley Ho was listed in an annex to a U.S. Department of Justice report, under the location "Hong Kong (and Macau)," which linked him to organized crime despite listing "unk" ("unknown") alongside his name.¹⁹⁶ It is concluded

[< BACK](#)

where the principle of *in dubio pro reo* applies, such as Macau.

In 1992, a U.S. Senate Subcommittee documented Stanley Ho's connection to the Triads in a hearing. This is part of a widely publicized report by the Division of Gaming Enforcement of New Jersey, which concluded: "While the material did not identify Stanley Ho as a member of a triad, it noted, 'Macau casinos are a major center of Asian organized crime activity, including money laundering and loan sharking, and while [the] exact role of Yip Hon and Stanley Ho in such criminal activity is unclear, they have been specifically linked to a number of criminal figures.'"¹⁹⁷

This association has always been denied on the grounds that there is "absolutely no basis for any suggestion" that Stanley had any connection with Macau's Triads or organized crime groups.¹⁹⁸ One thing seems certain: standards applied in one jurisdiction cannot be enforced as standards for other jurisdictions. What is required is a deep knowledge of the personal and business relationships that exist in a particular community, with particular cultural standards and different values. The fact alone of knowing and meeting members of the Triads is not sufficient, under Macau standards, to deem anyone unsuitable for a gaming license, under the former and the current legal and regulatory framework on casino gaming. The same applies to other jurisdictions such as Portugal, where STDM is a gaming concessionaire.

Another example of his alleged undesirable connections is the fact that Stanley Ho had interests in a casino in North Korea.¹⁹⁹ On this he said: "I've got full clearance from Washington. I was very cautious. I consulted the then U.S. Consul General in Hong Kong, who was kind enough to send my request to Washington: 'Do we give them a chance,' 'should I open it or not?' Three weeks later a message came from Washington and the Consul General [in Hong Kong] told me: 'Stanley Ho, you may proceed.' And I've got the green light also from the Macau Government."²⁰⁰

At this point, the question is raised as to whether hidden political forces may have kept Stanley Ho away from gambling markets such as the United States and Australia, because the competition was afraid of such a powerful empire. The

[< BACK](#)

August of 2006: “If you can’t stand the heat, get out of the kitchen.”²⁰¹

Two years earlier, on May 18, 2004, at the opening of the first new casino after the “liberalization”—Sands—Stanley publicly demonstrated his fair play to the competition, saying: “[W]e have the opportunity to learn from one another,” and, “[t]he cake is going to be bigger and bigger, and we all could have a share.”²⁰² However, he reportedly reacted differently, as one witness recounted: “[w]hen Stanley Ho went up the escalator and saw the Sands gaming floor, his jaw dropped,”²⁰³ summoning his inner circle and demanding action: “[w]e are Chinese, and we will not be disgraced. We will not lose to intruders.”²⁰⁴

For the man who said, “[g]aming should never be a win-lose proposition,” and had the motto “from society, to society”²⁰⁵ and for whom “no” was not in the dictionary, this contest was tough. SJM lost market share over the years²⁰⁶—which was to be expected since it benefited from the STDM monopoly—but more importantly, it was unable to reinvent its business model. SJM was the last to arrive in Cotai and only recently had a soft opening of its property: the Grand Lisboa Palace.²⁰⁷

There are certainly several reasons for this conservative approach. Being the successor of a 40-year-old monopolist company did not help. The fact that some of the best employees were recruited by competitors shortly after 2002 also played a role. However, from the 1980s until 2008, when the Grand Lisboa Hotel and casino opened, STDM/SJM underpinned its model on high rollers brought in by gaming promoters (junkets). This model suffered a major setback with the Central Government policy in 2014.

Gambling is now focused, and we risk saying that it will only survive if operators offer new experiences for the mass and premium mass markets rather than the VIP high rollers market. SJM only now has an integrated resort like its competitors. It stayed 20 years—almost the term of the concession—without a property to target the mass market.

[< BACK](#)

followed, was a defining moment for his life and for the emporium, which, with some exceptions, still rests on its successful past.

The past will never return and unfortunately there will be no other Stanley Ho²⁰⁸—the Maecenas charming dancer, eagle-eyed businessman, billionaire, sports fan, *bon vivant*, philanthropist, and friend to his friends—in Macau.

CONCLUSION

Despite the name “Macau” has its origin in the bay (in Cantonese “Gau”) where the temple of A-Má is located (A-Ma-Gau). This now almost 22-year-old Special Administrative Region of the People's Republic of China is inseparable of the name of Stanley Ho and, to a lesser extent, his predecessors.

These men were, in their respective roles and eras, decisive to shape the gaming industry. We may affirm that the controversial Stanley Ho contributed the most to the development of the gaming industry and concomitantly to the development of Macau.

Stanley Ho is a true legendary tycoon that shall be preserved in the minds of those who have interest in the gambling and entertainment industry. “King Stanley had a full life which be put on celluloid in a Hollywood movie,”²⁰⁹ and always respected the past and the culture of Macau.

Yet the due time of History will judge better the exact role of Stanley Ho and his predecessors, one thing shall be taken for granted: Macau and its residents owe a lot to the *taipan* outlined in this article.

The current times may not have stage for tycoons, kings, or moguls, as spreadsheets, results, and key performance indicators took their roles. But the lessons of the past given by the Macau gambling kingpins serve to understand the

[< BACK](#)

Footnotes

- ¹ | A. Pinho, *Chapter 11—Gambling in Macau, in* MACAU: CITY OF COMMERCE AND CULTURE—CONTINUITY AND CHANGE, at 155 (R.D. Cremer ed. 1987), ISBN 962-308-002-6; Bert Okuley and F. King Poole, *Gamblers' Guide to Macau*, SOUTH CHINA MORNING POST, 1979 (“A scandalized Franciscan friar, José de Jesus Maria, who was in Macau from 1742 to 1745, wrote of how the town was dominated by ‘lechery, robbery, treachery, gambling, drunkenness, brawling, wrangling, cheating, killing and other similar vices’”); INSPECTION OF THE GAMING CONTRACT, GAMING IN MACAU [Inspeção do Contrato de Jogos, O Jogo em Macau] (Government of Macau ed. 1985).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

- ² | FERNANDO VITÓRIA AND ÓSCAR ALBERTO MADUREIRA, GAMING LAW IN MACAU—EVOLUTION, HISTORY AND LEGISLATION [original in Portuguese, O Direito do Jogo em Macau—Evolução, História e Legislação].

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

- ³ | Metaphorically, it has the same weight in the economy as oil in the Middle East or in Texas, garlic in Gilroy (California), or potatoes in Blackfoot (Idaho).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

- ⁴ | 1847, if we consider the legalization of the Chinese lottery.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

- ⁵ | See JORGE GODINHO, THE MACAU CASINOS—HISTORY OF THE BIGGEST GAMES OF FORTUNE AND CHANCE MARKET OF THE WORLD [original in Portuguese, Os Casinos de Macau—História do Maior Mercado de Jogos de Fortuna ou Azar do Mundo]. The

[< BACK](#)[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

- ⁶ | The pejorative name for these workers is “coolie,” defined as “an unskilled native laborer in India, China, and some other Asian countries”—see *Colie, Cooly*, OXFORD ENGLISH DICTIONARY (2d ed. 1989), <https://www.oed.com/oed2/00049458;jsessionid=5BFEC8C98132480B734F80917EC505E>. In the United States, Chap. 27—An Act to Prohibit the “Coolie Trade” by American Citizens in American Vessels, approved by the Congress on Feb. 19, 1862.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

- ⁷ | Still in operation in Macau. There is a building in Macau at Avenida Infante D. Henrique which is known by that name and where lottery tickets and other types of non-casino games can be acquired.

- ⁸ | See GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 27. The year 1849 is debated among authors, with some stating 1847 and others 1850. We consider 1849 more accurate, in line with the views and sources mentioned by Godinho.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

- ⁹ | Reference made in a travel book called THE HONG KONG GUIDE, first published in 1893—see CHRISTINA BING CHENG MIU, MACAU: A CULTURAL JANUS, at 136 (Hong Kong University Press ed. 1999).

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

- ¹⁰ | See GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 27; Luís Pessanha, *The Games of Fortune and Chance and the Promotion of Investment in Macau* [original in Portuguese, Os Jogos de Fortuna ou Azar e a Promoção do Investimento em Macau], 20 ADMINISTRAÇÃO 847–888 (2007).

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)

Cau, Lou Cheok Chi, and Lou lok Nok.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

-
- 12 | Catarina Domingues, *Lou Kau, The first gaming tycoon* [original in Portuguese, Lou Kau, O Primeiro Magnata do Jogo] REVISTA MACAU (Oct. 25, 2017), at 66–69.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

-
- 13 | A drug extracted from the poppy plant.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

-
- 14 | Through an *Yinhao* (銀號), an old-style Chinese private bank. See *also* Domingues, *supra* note 12.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

-
- 15 | Shenghua Lou, *Charitable and Public Interest Actions Carried Out by the Macau Gaming Sector Until the Abolition of the Monopoly* [original in Portuguese, *cções de Beneficência e de Interesse Público a Cargo do Sector do Jogo de Macau Até à Abolição do Monopólio*], 27 ADMINISTRAÇÃO 385–408 (2014). According to this author, Lou Kau was a successful fantan bidder for Taipa, in partnership with Hu Gunchen, for the periods 1883–1884, and 1885–1886, for Macau, in partnership with Ho Lin Von, for the periods 1885–1886, 1886–1887, 1887–1888, and 1888–1889, and for Macau, by himself alone, for the periods 1889–1894, and 1894–1905.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

-
- 16 | Staff Reporter, *Macau Mansion Hides Story of Wealth and Tragedy*, MACAO MAGAZINE, Jan. 2010, at 98.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)

PREVALENCE AND TREATMENT (Springer ed. 2016). According to the authors, Pacapio (白鴿票) is a traditional game developed from pigeon racing in Guangdong Province, introduced to Macau in the late Qing Dynasty (1636–1912). “In the earlier version of the game, birds were identified with names based on traditional Chinese literature known as “Qianziwen” (Thousand-Character Essay). The players can place bets on the competing pigeons. This racing later evolved to a game similar to a lucky draw, in which players wagered on 10 of 80 characters written on a piece of paper. The players won if five or more chosen characters matched the drawn characters. Today, the game employs numbers instead of text and the manual control balloting has been replaced by computerization.” Game Inspection. See *supra* note 1, at 13.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

18 | See Domingues, *supra* note 12.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

19 | The most important in financial terms. It was an annual lottery “run on the basis of the family names of the candidates that passed the Chinese imperial examinations”—see JOÃO DE PINA-CABRAL, BETWEEN CHINA AND EUROPE: PERSON, CULTURE AND EMOTION IN MACAU, at 89 (Continuum ed. 2002). See *also* 90–93 for more details on the Vaeseng.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

20 | Staff Reporter, *supra* note 16, at 99.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

21 | *Id.*, where reference is made to documents disclosed to the Macau government showing Lou Kau had given up his Portuguese citizenship and reverted to being a Chinese national.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)

Chinese medical services before Sun Yat-Sen brought Western medicine services to the hospital.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

23 | Domingues, *supra* note 12.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

24 | Staff Reporter, *supra* note 16, at 98.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

25 | “[I]t is the only such organization in the whole country to have provided an uninterrupted service since its inception. From its humble origins in providing food, clothes and medicine to the poor, it has grown into a sizable institution with 260 employees and an annual turnover of 70 million patacas. It runs five nurseries, a primary and secondary school, an adult-education centre, three medical clinics and pharmacies, and gives out rice and cooking oil each month to 550 people in need. Each day its centres receive an average of 3,000 people—more than a million per year”—see Mark O'Neill, *A Friend in Need—Charity Serves the Poor for 110 Years*, MACAO MAG., July 1, 2011, at 35.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

26 | Lou, *supra* note 15, 397.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

27 | *Id.* at 400.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

29 | Macau Official Gazette No. 23, of June 9, 1894, at 278.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

30 | Staff Reporter, *supra* note 16, at 98.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

31 | See Cultural Affairs Bureau, Macau Government, *Lou Kau Mansion*, WORLD HERITAGE: MACAU, <https://www.wh.mo/LouKau/en/> (last visited May 3, 2021).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

32 | Staff Reporter, *supra* note 16, at 98.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

33 | See GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 96.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

34 | See Pinho, *supra* note 1, at 157 (“In the era of the Tai Xing Co [Tai Heng], gambling blossomed in Macau, especially after the Chinese Government in 1949 banned all gambling inside China. Tai Xing Co succeeded regularly in securing the monopoly for itself, apparently by a carefully-designed policy that excluded other potential bidders.”).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

36 | See GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 102.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

37 | *Id.*, at 104.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

38 | During our research we found the following aliases for Kou Hou Neng: Gao Kening, Gau Ke Ning, and Ko Hor Ning.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

39 | Leung Kai-Chun, *Formation and Evolution of Macao Tung Sin Tong's Management in Its Early Stages (1892–1949)*, REVIEW OF CULTURE, 2016, at 25.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

40 | According to the Macau Official Gazette No. 9, of February 27, 1915, at 123, Kou Ho Neng was born in 1879 and not in 1878, which is mentioned in the majority of the texts found during the research.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

41 | In Hong Kong, “Tak Wing Pawn Shop (德榮大押, established in 1940) on Des Voeux Road Central, Tak Sang Pawn Shop (德生押, established in 1940) at 178 Shanghai Street in Yau Ma Tei, Tak Tai Pawn Shop (德泰押) at Queen's Road West, Tung Tak Pawn Shop (同德大押, taken over by the Ko family in 1947, demolished in 2015) in Wanchai and Tak Chuen's neighbor Tak Hing Pawn Shop (launched in the same year as Tak Chuen). (...) [T]he Ko family's Foo Shing Loan & Mortgage Co Ltd (富成按揭, incorporated in 1953) also operates several other pawn shops in HK and

[< BACK](#)

(德泉酒庄) and “Double Happiness” Wines, THE INDUSTRIAL HISTORY OF HONG KONG GROUP (June 26, 2020), <https://industrialhistoryhk.org/tak-chuen-distillery-%E5%BE%B7%E6%B3%89%E9%85%92%E5%BA%84-and-double-happiness-wines/> (last visited May 3, 2021).

[<](#) Go to Footnote

42 | “Fan” means number of times, and ‘tan,’ to divide. According to Xavier Paulès, *Gambling in China Reconsidered: Fantan in South China During the Early Twentieth Century*, 7 INT’L J. ASIAN STUD. 179–200 (2010), at 179 and 182: “Fantan 番攤 is a Chinese gambling game based on a draw from a random number of hidden coins or tokens, requiring the player to guess a number out of one, two, three or four. It currently survives only in Macao, but during the Late Qing and Republican periods, fantan was one of the most popular games in South China.” “Fantan could be played by a single gambler as well as by dozens of gamblers. It was played on a very large table (...). In front of the croupier there was a small pile of tokens (tanpi 攤皮), such as cash (old copper coins with a hole in the middle) or porcelain buttons, hidden beneath a brass cover, so that it was impossible for the gamblers to count them. In the middle of the table was a square slab of zinc. Each side of the square represented a number: 1, 2, 3 and 4. Gamblers chose one (or several) of the sides to place their stakes. When all the stakes had been laid down, the croupier uncovered the heap and slowly began to draw out four coins at a time with a bamboo stick. Ultimately, the heap was depleted until either one, two, three or four remained. If a player had guessed correctly, then he was a winner. The casino derived profit only from a percentage deducted from the gross earnings. During the first half of the twentieth century this percentage was 10 percent.”

[<](#) Go to Footnote

43 | In 1910, 70% of the Portuguese Administration of Macau's income came from gambling and opium—see HAO ZHIDONG, *MACAU HISTORY AND SOCIETY*, at 75 (Hong Kong University Press and University of Macau ed. 2011).

[<](#) Go to Footnote

[< BACK](#)

d=75169.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

45 | Kai-Chun, *supra* note 39, at 26.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

46 | *Id.* at 25.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

47 | Years as director of the Tung Sin Tong Charitable Society: 1922, 1923, 1924, 1925, 1926, 1927, 1928—see *id.* at 24.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

48 | The Macau Chinese Chamber of Commerce (澳門中華總商會 in Chinese, and Associação Comercial de Macau, in Portuguese), is one of the most influential business associations in Macau. It was established on January 8, 1913, as the Macao Chamber of Commerce, and was officially changed to its current name in 1916—see *History—An Outline History of Macao Chamber of Commerce*, MACAO CHAMBER OF COMMERCE, <http://www.acm.org.mo/index.php/en/acm-intro/history/> (last visited May 3, 2021).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

49 | 德成按, in Chinese, and Casa de Penhores Tak Seng On, in Portuguese. During the Pacific War, pawnshops prospered in part from the business of the huge number of refugees from mainland China escaping from internal conflicts, and Hong Kong residents who escaped from the Japanese invasion of the British colony.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)

Lisboa.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

51 | Mark O'Neill, *Taking Credit: Pawnshops Play a Key Role in Macao's Economic History*, MACAO MAG., Apr. 2012, at 24.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

52 | Its importance can be measured by the fact that the Macau pavilion at the World Exposition 2010, held in Shanghai, housed a replica of the Tak Seng On Pawnshop building.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

53 | O'Neill, *supra* note 51, at 23.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

54 | One of the recollections of Leung Wa, cashier of Tak Seng On when it closed, that can be listened to when visiting the museum.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

55 | “[P]awnshop businesses were governmental-regulated in Macao from 1903, with laws that classified pawn-shops into Tong, On and Ngat. (...) In shops which offered On pledges, loans could be arranged for one or two years at a slightly higher rate of interest than that provided by Tong dealers. (...) One of the most usual items pawned in former times were heavy winter clothes, such as meen laap (“padded jackets”) and meen toi (“paddle quilts”). These were thoroughly cleaned at the end of spring to eliminate lice, mites and other vermin, handed in and pawned, then stored for the summer in the pawn-shop and redeemed—if one's finances permitted, of course—at the beginning of the next winter.” See JASON WORDIE, MACAO: PEOPLE AND PLACES, PAST AND PRESENT, at 356 (Angsana Limited ed. 2013).

[< BACK](#)

56 | CHUN TING ZHU, BIOGRAPHY OF STANLEY HO (in Chinese), at 105–106 (Guangdong Economic Publishing House ed. 2001).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

57 | The British government of Hong Kong prohibited gambling in Hong Kong in 1872.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

58 | Shenghua Lou, *Development and Change in Macau Society in the First Half of the 20th Century* [original in Portuguese, Shenghua Lou, *Desenvolvimento e Mudança na Sociedade de Macau na Primeira Metade do Século XX*], 28 *ADMINISTRAÇÃO* 579–598 (2015), at 587.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

59 | The nine friends were Pang Weiting, Mei Weitang, Li Runsheng, Liang Yujian, Huang Kongshan, Zhou Zhongpeng, Liang Ziguang, Mo Qingjiang, and Huang Yaochu—see Macau Archives File No. MO/AM/DA/005/02/002, *supra* note 44; Kai-Chun, *supra* note 39, at 25.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

60 | “Sup Yau Tong,” in Cantonese, and “Salão dos Dez Amigos,” in Portuguese.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

61 | “These gaming houses are usually of one story only, and on the ground floor (which you enter at once from the street, there being no hall or anteroom) you will find an ill-lighted and ill-ventilated room, some thirty feet by fifty feet, the sole furniture of which is a table about six feet square and four feet high”—see Circumnavigator (pseud.), *Macao, The Monte Carlo of The Orient*, XV in *THE OUTLINE OF KNOWLEDGE—TRAVEL* 304–308 (James A. Richards ed. 1924), at 304.

[< BACK](#)

62 | Kai-Chun, *supra* note 39, at 25.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

63 | 總統酒店, in Chinese.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

64 | In 1930, after winning the first monopoly for the gaming operations, Iun Iun Company used the hotel and changed its name.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

65 | CHAN, LI, AND LEUNG, *supra* note 17, at 14.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

66 | *Id.* at 15–16.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

67 | 泰興公司, in Chinese, and Companhia Tai Heng, in Portuguese. Aka “Taixing Company” and “Tai Hing Company.”

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

68 | GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 168.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

70 | Glenn McCartney, *Stanley Ho Hung-sun: The "King of Gambling,"* in *GIANTS OF TOURISM* 170–181 (Richard W. Butler and Roslyn Russell ed. 2010), at 173.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

71 | Leonor Sá Machado, *Hotel Central: Avenida de Almeida Ribeiro's Teal Landmark*, *MACAU LIFESTYLE* (Feb. 7, 2020), <https://macaulifestyle.com/culture/heritage/hotel-central-avenida-de-almeida-ribeiros-teal-landmark/>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

72 | CECÍLIA JORGE AND ROGÉRIO BELTRÃO COELHO, *ROQUE CHOI: ONE MAN TWO SYSTEMS* [original in Portuguese, *Roque Choi: Um Homem Dois Sistemas*], at 44 (Livros do Oriente ed. 2015).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

73 | GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 170.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

74 | CHAN, LI, AND LEUNG, *supra* note 17, at 16.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

75 | Circumnavigator (pseud.), *supra* note 61, at 307.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)

Macau was one of them. Later, the articles were compiled in the book *THRILLING CITIES*, published in 1963 by Signet Books, London.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

77 | Ian Fleming, *Macao*, in *THRILLING CITIES* 23–37 (ebook (Version 1.0) ed. 2013), at 26.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

78 | “The registered trademark for Tak Chuen's wines is ‘Double Happiness,’ which is identical to the ‘Double Happiness’ logo that is used in all of the Ko family's pawnshops. (...) Tak Chuen had several dozen large centuries-old jars to store wine, including one called the ‘Eternal Spring Jar’ which was allegedly given to the Tang dynasty poet Li Po.” The distillery is still in operation today. See York, *supra* note 41.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

79 | For details on several of the donations given by Kou Ho Neng, see Lou, *supra* note 15, and Kai-Chun, *supra* note 39.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

80 | The inscription below his bronze bust at Tung Sin Tong Charitable Society's courtyard (authored by Zhou Ruzhen, a famous gentry of the Qing dynasty) gives note of his donations to this entity: “[He] successively and over time made several generous donations totaling twenty thousand patacas until 1939, for the change and reconstruction of its headquarters, creation of a free school, as well as free consultations and medicines.” According to the *Va Kio* newspaper edition of December 31, 1939, cited by Lou, *supra* note 15, at 397, “[o]n the very day of the unveiling of his bust, Kou Ho Neng made a donation to Tung Sin Tong of 20 cent coins worth 10,000 Patacas that was intended to create a pharmacy.”

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)

Second World War, 46 J. IMPERIAL AND COMMONWEALTH HISTORY 1125–1147 (2018).

[< Go to Footnote](#)

82 | See inscription below his bronze bust located in the courtyard of the Tung Sin Tong Charitable Society.

[< Go to Footnote](#)

83 | “[T]he money came from 56 people, including Gou Ho-ling, a prominent casino operator and pawnbroker, who gave 5,000 patacas, the then governor who donated HK \$300, and prostitutes on a nearby street who each gave 10 patacas”—see O'Neill, *supra* note 25, at 37.

[< Go to Footnote](#)

84 | “His 3 wives and 11 sons each dedicated 400 and 500 dollars respectively”—see Kai-Chun, *supra* note 39, at 26.

[< Go to Footnote](#)

85 | O'Neill, *supra* note 25, at 35.

[< Go to Footnote](#)

86 | Macau Archives File No. MO/AM/DA/005/02/002, *supra* note 44.

[< Go to Footnote](#)

87 | *Id.*

[< Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)[hp?id=1&hl=en.](#)[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

89 | MANUEL TEIXEIRA, *TOponymy of Macau II* [original in Portuguese, *Toponímia de Macau II*], at 504 (Macau Cultural Institute ed. 1997).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

90 | He received the award on June 28, 1952, during the visit of the Minister of Overseas to Macau—see I OVERSEAS MINISTRY, *FIRST REPORT OF THE FIRST TRIP OF THE MINISTER OF OVERSEAS TO THE OVERSEAS PROVINCES 1952* [original in Portuguese, II Ministério do Ultramar, *Primeira Relação da Primeira Viagem do Ministro do Ultramar às Províncias Ultramarinas 1952*] (General Overseas Agency ed. 1954), at 397.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

91 | JOÃO GUEDES, *THE SECTS—THE TRIADS—HISTORIES OF CRIME AND POLITICS IN MACAU* [original in Portuguese, *As Seitas—Histórias do Crime e da Política em Macau*], at 119–122 (Livros do Oriente ed. 1999).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

92 | *Id.* at 121.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

93 | Approved by the Loyal Senate (the City Hall at the time) session of October 12, 1955—see Macau Official Gazette No. 53, of October 22, 1955, at 717.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)

supra note 55, at 314.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

95 | The most exclusive neighborhood of Macau, where the Palace assigned to the governors of Macau (and currently to the chief executive of Macau) is located.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

96 | Still in Kou Ho Neng's family estate.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

97 | Still a local landmark. It is included in the “Footprints of Chinese Merchants of Macao” historic walk sponsored by the Municipal Affairs Bureau (Division of Civic Education of the Department of Cultural and Recreational Affairs and Civic Education) of the Macau government.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

98 | For a description of its exterior, see *WORDIE*, *supra* note 55, at 194.

[+ Show Footnotes](#)

99 | The Ko Ho Ning Memorial Primary School (高可寧紀念小學), located in Kwai Chung, New Territories, <http://www.twhghkhnmp.edu.hk/>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

100 | Victoria Peak. “The Peak remains an upmarket residential area, although residency today is based on wealth”—see *Victoria Peak*, WIKIPEDIA (2021), https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Victoria_Peak.

[<](#) BACK

101 | Macau Archives File No. MO/AM/DA/005/02/002, *supra* note 44.

[<](#) Go to Footnote

102 | WORDIE, *supra* note 55, at 315; TEIXEIRA, *supra* note 89, at 505.

[<](#) Go to Footnote

103 | Born Fu Tak-yung. During our research we found the following aliases for Fu Tak lam: Fu Deyong, Fu Laorong, Fu Lau Rong, Fu Lo Yung, Fu Lou long, and Fu Tak long.

[<](#) Go to Footnote

104 | ADRIAN FU, THE FU TAK LAM STORY, at 27 (Fu Tak lam Foundation Limited ed. 2018).

[<](#) Go to Footnote

105 | João Botas, *Fu tak lam, First Gaming Tycoon* [original in Portuguese, Fu Tak lam, Primeiro Magnata do Jogo], MACAU ANTIGO (Feb. 3, 2018), <https://macauantigo.blogspot.com/2018/02/fu-tak-iam-primeiro-magnata-do-jogo.html> (last visited May 3, 2021).

[<](#) Go to Footnote

106 | Fu, *supra* note 104, at 31.

[<](#) Go to Footnote

107 | “Fu Deyong.”

[< BACK](#)

108 | Fu, *supra* note 104, at 63.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

109 | According to João Botas—see Andreia Sofia Silva, *Family of Fu Tak Iam, One of the First Gaming Tycoons, Creates Foundation in Macau* [original in Portuguese, Família de Fu Tak Iam, Um dos Primeiros Magnatas do Jogo, Cria Fundação em Macau], HOJE MACAU, Feb. 2, 2018, <https://hojemacau.com.mo/2018/02/02/casinos-familia-de-fu-tak-iam-primeiro-magnata-do-jogo-cria-fundacao-em-macau/> (last visited May 3, 2021). See *also* MARK O'NEILL, PIONEERS OF MACAU—THE STORY OF 14 CHINESE WHO HELPED TO MAKE THE CITY, at 113 (International Institute of Macau ed. 2018).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

110 | Fu, *supra* note 104, at 63–83.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

111 | RICHARD HUGHES, BORROWED PLACE, BORROWED TIME: HONG KONG AND ITS MANY FACES, at 154 (Andre Deutsch ed. 1976).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

112 | CHAN, LI, AND LEUNG, *supra* note 17, at 16.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

113 | HUGHES, *supra* note 111, at 154.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

114 | Mark O'Neill, *Grandson of Macao Gambling Mogul Publishes Biography*, 50 MACAO MAG., Jan. 1, 2019, at 77.

[< BACK](#)

115 | One of Macau's most important temples. It was where the Treaty of Wang-Hsia (aka the Treaty of Mong-Há), the first formal pact of friendship between China and the U.S., was signed in 1844, the terms having been agreed between the Machu Imperial Commissioner Qiying and the Envoy Extraordinary and Minister Plenipotentiary of the United States to China, Caleb Cushing.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

116 | The exact sum was never officially confirmed. It was rumored at the time to exceed US\$150,000—see *WORDIE*, *supra* note 55, at 63.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

117 | PHILLIPE PONS, *MACAO* (Hong Kong University Press ed. 1999), cited by McCartney, *supra* note 70, at 173.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

118 | According to O'NEILL, *supra* note 109, at 119, “[t]here was more mediation, this time by Xin Ma Shi Zeng, a famous Cantonese opera star, and the figure decreased again to 500,000 patacas.”

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

119 | *Fu*, *supra* note 104, at 149.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

120 | *Id.* at 141.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

122 | He received the award on June 28, 1952, during the visit of the Portuguese Overseas Minister to Macau—see II OVERSEAS MINISTRY, *supra* note 90, at 397.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

123 | Created by public deed on April 25, 2017, and recognized by the Chief Executive Order of August 3, 2017 (published in the Macau Official Gazette No. 34, Series II, of August 23, 2017). The Bylaws are published in the Macau Official Gazette No. 5, Series II, of January 31, 2018.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

124 | DAVID G. SCHWARTZ, *ROLL THE BONES—THE HISTORY OF GAMBLING, CASINO EDITION*, at 349 (Winchester Books ed. 2013).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

125 | *Dutch-Japanese Relations*, KINGDOM OF THE NETHERLANDS, <https://www.netherlandsandyou.nl/your-country-and-the-netherlands/japan/and-the-netherlands/dutch-japanese-relations>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

126 | “*Comprador* (in Portuguese: “buyer”), also spelled *Compradore*, a member of the Chinese merchant class who aided Western traders in China in the late 18th, 19th, and early 20th centuries. Hired by contract, the comprador was responsible for a Chinese staff of currency-exchange specialists, interpreters, coolies, and guardsmen. Many compradors became extremely wealthy and established businesses of their own. In recent times, the term comprador has come to denote those people who aided Western exploitation of China.”—see Editors of Encyclopaedia Britannica, *Comprador*, BRITANNICA, <https://www.britannica.com/topic/comprador>.

[< BACK](#)

AQUI HÁ HISTÓRIA (2020), https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_MeE2WP27gg.

[<](#) Go to Footnote

127 | Carla Araújo, *Jurisdição Mista*, III DITEMA, THEMATIC DICTIONARY OF MACAU 812 (University of Macau ed. 2010).

[<](#) Go to Footnote

128 | *Dutch-Japanese Relations*, *supra* note 125.

[<](#) Go to Footnote

129 | *Id.*

[<](#) Go to Footnote

130 | *Id.*

[<](#) Go to Footnote

131 | Henriette Rahusen-De Bruyn Kops, *Not Such an 'Unpromising Beginning': The First Dutch Trade Embassy to China, 1655–1657*, 36 MOD. ASIA STUD. 535–578 (2002).

[<](#) Go to Footnote

132 | *Id.* at 535.

[<](#) Go to Footnote

[< BACK](#)[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

134 | Jung Moon-Ho, *Coolies and Cane: Race, Labor, and Sugar in the Age of Emancipation* (Review by Carol Huang), 92 J. AFRICAN AMERICAN HISTORY 120–122 (2007).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

135 | LUCY M. COHEN, CHINESE IN THE POST-CIVIL WAR SOUTH: A PEOPLE WITHOUT HISTORY, at 69 (LSU Press ed. 1999).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

136 | Chap. 27—An Act to prohibit the “Coolie Trade” by American Citizens in American Vessels, approved on Feb. 19, 1862.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

137 | See, on this, *The Group*, JARDINES, <https://www.jardines.com/en/about-us#jardine-matheson-8>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

138 | *China's Financial Position Sound—Capable of Solving her Own Troubles*, CHINA MAIL, Nov. 26, 1921, https://mmis.hkpl.gov.hk/coverpage/-/coverpage/view?_coverpage_WAR_mmisportalportlet_hsf=china+mail+1921-11-26&p_r_p_-1078056564_c=QF757YsWv5%2FYxWHIw1Z7kfkeA4hc78Wd&_coverpage_WAR_mmisportalportlet_o=1&_coverpage_WAR_mmisportalportlet_actual_q=%28%20verbatim_dc.collection%3A%28%22Old%5C%20HK%5C%20Newspapers%22%29%20%29%20AND+%28%20%28%20allTermsMandatory%3A%28true%29%20OR+all_dc.title%3A%28china+mail+1921-11-26%29%20OR+all_dc.creator%3A%28china+mail+1921-11-26%29%20OR+all_dc.contributor%3A%28china+mail+1921-11-26%29%20OR+all_dc.subject%3A%28china+mail+1921-11-26%29%20OR+fulltext%3A%28china+mail+1921-11-26%29%20OR+all_dc.description%3A%28china+mail+1921-11-26%29%20%29%20%29&_coverpage_WAR_mmisportalportlet_sort_field=score&_coverpage_WAR_mmisportalportlet_sort_order=desc.

[< BACK](#)

139 | Current purpose of the school. See *School History*, QUEEN'S COLLEGE, <https://www.qc.edu.hk/en/site/view?name=School+History>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

140 | *Id.*

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

141 | QUEEN'S COLLEGE MUSEUM, *Oral History Interview with Dr Stanley Ho, OQC* (2007), <https://www.jardines.com/en/about-us#jardine-matheson-8>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

142 | *Id.*

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

143 | *Id.*

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

144 | *Id.*

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

145 | *Id.*

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

147 | *Three Years and Eight Months: Hong Kong During the Japanese Occupation*, HONG KONG UNIV. SCI. & TECH., <https://library.ust.hk/exhibitions/japanese-occupation/?page=Intro>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

148 | In Portuguese, Companhia Cooperativa de Macau, Limitada.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

149 | Among which was Sir Robert Hotung. See *History of Macau* (in Portuguese), WIKIPÉDIA, https://pt.wikipedia.org/wiki/História_de_Macau#Escassez_de_alimentos_e_Companhia_Cooperativa_de_Macau.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

150 | See, *on this*, Lou, *supra* note 58.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

151 | *Id.* Other sources mention 500,000. See João Guedes, *Bombing in Macau* (in Portuguese), AQUI HÁ HISTÓRIA (Oct. 22, 2014), <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NDLzko1Tm5k>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

152 | Ana Isabel Dias, *Dr. Ho's Promise* (in Portuguese), YOUTUBE (May 27, 2020), <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IoTa3Z8hUcU>; David Thruston, *Me Stanley Ho, Portrait of An Enigma*, SOUTH CHINA MORNING POST, Apr. 9, 1990 (in the words of Stanley Ho: “Before my mother died, I promised her I would make good by hook or by crook.”).

[<](#) BACK

153 | Ricardo Pinto, *A Show Is Never a One-Man Show*, MACAU CLOSER (2007), <https://macaucloser.com/en/magazine/departure-legend>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

154 | *History of Macau*, *supra* note 149.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

155 | Lou, *supra* note 58, at 585.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

156 | *Id.* (until the end of 1944, Macau had 300 stores trading gold, silver, and exchange houses).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

157 | *Id.* at 586.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

158 | Dias, *supra* note 152.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

159 | Guedes, *supra* note 151.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

¹⁶¹ | João Botas, *The Gold ... After the Opium*, MACAU ANTIGO (Apr. 21, 2009), <http://macauantigo.blogspot.com/2009/04/o-ouro-depois-do-opio.html>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

¹⁶² | *Id.*

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

¹⁶³ | *Id.* The gold trade had been regulated in the beginning of the 1940s through an international treaty intended to control the price. This treaty was not subscribed to by Macau. See also on this topic, André Vinagre, *Pedro José Lobo, Between Opium, Gold, and Gaming Chips* [original in Portuguese, *Entre o Ópio, o Ouro e As Fichas de Jogo*], PONTO FINAL (Nov. 27, 2019), <https://pontofinalmacau.wordpress.com/2019/11/27/pedro-jose-lobo-entre-o-opio-o-ouro-e-as-fichas-de-jogo/>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

¹⁶⁴ | On the gold trade in this period, see VASCO SILVÉRIO MARQUES AND ANÍBAL MESQUITA BORGES, *GOLD ON THE HONG KONG/MACAU AXIS (1946–1973)* [original in Portuguese, *O Ouro No Eixo Hong Kong/Macau (1946–1973)*] (Instituto Português do Oriente ed. 2012); Order No. 4176, published in the Macau Official Gazette of June 21, 1947.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

¹⁶⁵ | Andreia Sofia Silva, *Gold on the Hong Kong/Macau Axis Interview with Vasco Silvério Marques and Aníbal Mesquita Borges* [original in Portuguese, *O Ouro No Eixo Hong Kong/Macau Entrevista com Vasco Silvério Marques e Aníbal Mesquita Borges*], MACAU ANTIGO (Sept. 26, 2012), <http://macauantigo.blogspot.com/2012/09/o-ouro-no-eixo-hong-kong-macau.html>.

[< BACK](#)

166 | Botas, *supra* note 161; Order No. 4176, published in the Macau Official Gazette of June 21, 1947.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

167 | GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 296.

[+ Show Footnotes](#)

168 | *Id.* at 296; Pinto, *supra* note 153.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

169 | Pinto, *supra* note 153, in the words of Stanley Ho.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

170 | GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 297.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

171 | *Id.* at 298.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

172 | *Id.* at 157 (“During the decades of 1930 to 1950, as a result of the international context and the new Portuguese reality resulting from the ‘National Revolution’ of May 28th, 1926, it was sought to always pass the message that the ultimate ambition and aspiration of the Portuguese administration was to abolish the gaming” (free translation)).

[< BACK](#)

173 | From 500,000 during the war years, Macau had 167,794 in 1960.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

174 | Cortés, *supra* note 35, at 55. Jaime Silvério Marques (1915–1986) was the governor of Macau between September 18, 1959, and April 17, 1962, and oversaw the public tender which culminated in the award of the concession to STDM. The confidential letter (Ofício no. 1625/320, of November 8, 1960) to Overseas Minister Vasco Lopes Alves, in Portugal, is fully transcribed in GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 255–260.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

175 | GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 303.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

176 | Stanley Ho, Interview to CNN, Oct. 13, 2004, cited by GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 298.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

177 | See in general on the bidding amount, MARCO LOBO, *EVERYDAY IS MINE—THE LIFE OF PEDRO JOSÉ LOBO*, at 186 (International Institute of Macau ed. 2020) (“Pedro [Lobo] had managed the process of receiving the gambling bids for many years. An amusing anecdote was recounted by John Pownall Reeves in his memoir. The story goes that on one occasion the usual sealed tenders were to be opened by Mr. Lobo. One only had up to then been presented, that of the Company which had held the concession for many years [Tai Heng]. At the last moment another envelope was presented, to the consternation of the Concessionary Company who asked for another five minutes, at the end of which they entered a tender for an extra quarter of million. Mr. Lobo then drew from the other envelope a blank sheet of paper and blandly remarked that evidently the Company was not finding taxation too heavy. This story at least deserves to be true.”).

[< BACK](#)

178 | Pinto, *supra* note 153, in the words of Stanley Ho.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

179 | FERNANDO LIMA AND EDUARDO CINTRA TORRES, *MACAU BETWEEN TWO WORLDS, INTERVIEW WITH STANLEY Ho (in Portuguese)*, at 57 (Jorge Álvares Foundation and Editorial Survey ed. 2004), cited by GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 305.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

180 | *Id.*

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

181 | LIMA AND CINTRA TORRES, *supra* note 179, at 202 (cited by GODINHO, *supra* note 5, at 307).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

182 | Dias, *supra* note 152.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

183 | Brother-in-law of Stanley Ho, married to his sister Susie Ho.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

184 | ANTÓNIO LOBO VILELA, *MACAU GAMING LAW—ANNOTATED WITH COMMENTS, VOL. IV: ARTICLES 32 TO 57, Note 5 to Article 50*, at 355–356 (PC Consulting Ltd. ed. 2020).

[< BACK](#)[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

186 | Portugal-Hong Kong Chamber of Commerce and Industry, *Honouring the Life and Legacy of Dr. Stanley Ho—Interview No. 6 with General Vasco Rocha Vieira*, YOUTUBE (Oct. 2, 2020), <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LLkxzxo0nFo>.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

187 | André Vinagre, *Stanley Ho: Death of the Patriarch of Modern Macau* [original in Portuguese, *Stanley Ho: Morreu o Patriarca da Macau Moderna*], PONTO FINAL (May 26, 2020), <https://pontofinalmacau.wordpress.com/2020/05/27/stanley-ho-morreu-o-patriarca-da-macau-moderna/> (“[Álvaro] Rodrigues reveals a sentence that Stanley used to say: “What is good for Macau is good for STDM, and what is good for STDM is good for Macau”).

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

188 | Episode known historically as the 1-2-3 event.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

189 | GARCIA LEANDRO, *MACAU IN THE YEARS OF THE PORTUGUESE REVOLUTION* [original in Portuguese, *Macau Nos Anos da Revolução Portuguesa*] at 34 (Gradiva ed. 2011).

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

190 | Cortés, *supra* note 35, at 51.

[↩ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

192 | Dias, *supra* note 152.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

193 | Dias, *supra* note 152.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

194 | Mimi Chan, *About Stanley Ho [Short Interview with Pedro Cortés]* (2021). The quote is from Beltrão Coelho.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

195 | *Miu*, *supra* note 9, at 206. The interview was conducted by the co-author Pedro Cortés directly with Mimi Chan in April 2021.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

196 | Special Report of the Division of Gaming Enforcement to the Casino Control Commission on its investigation of MGM Mirage Joint Venture with Pansy Ho in Macau, Special Administrative Region, People's Republic of China (2009), https://www.state.nj.us/casinos/home/info/docs/MGM/dge_%20report_redacted.pdf, at 50.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

197 | *Id.* at 50–51.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)

[s://www.wsj.com/articles/SB10001424052748704207504575129102781344536](https://www.wsj.com/articles/SB10001424052748704207504575129102781344536).

[< Go to Footnote](#)

199 | As well as a racetrack in Iran in the 1970s, among other “exotic” investments.

[< Go to Footnote](#)

200 | Pinto, *supra* note 152, in the words of Stanley Ho.

[< Go to Footnote](#)

201 | Attributed to Sheldon Adelson—see Justine Lao, *Sands Chief Says Macao Fight to Intensify*, FINANCIAL TIMES (Aug. 29, 2006), <https://www.ft.com/content/d6a83482-36bb-11db-89d6-0000779e2340>.

[< Go to Footnote](#)

202 | Newsdesk, *Time of Sands*, IAG (INSIDE ASIA GAMING) (May 13, 2014), <https://www.asgam.com/index.php/2014/05/13/time-of-sands/>.

[< Go to Footnote](#)

203 | *Id.*

[< Go to Footnote](#)

204 | *Id.*

[< Go to Footnote](#)

[< BACK](#)

[p/2020/05/26/stanley-ho-father-of-modern-macau/](#).

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

206 | In Q2 of 2021, SJM had solely 11.7% of market share in terms of GGR. See Renato Marques, *Sands Continues to Lead Gaming Market in Q2*, MACAU DAILY TIMES (Aug. 18, 2021), <https://macaudailytimes.com.mo/sands-continues-to-lead-gaming-market-with-24-9-share-in-q2.html>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

207 | Oscar Guijarro, *SJM's Grand Lisboa Palace to Open This Friday*, IAG (July 29, 2021), <https://www.asgam.com/index.php/2021/07/29/sjms-grand-lisboa-palace-to-open-this-friday/>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

208 | Pedro Cortés, *The King, Dato' Sri Stanley Ho Hung-sun*, MACAU BUS. (June 22, 2018), <https://www.macaubusiness.com/the-king-dato-sri-stanley-ho-hung-sun/>.

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

209 | *Id.*

[↶ Go to Footnote](#)

Topics

[Casino games](#)[Gambling](#)[Gambling economics](#)[Gaming laws and regulations](#)[Law and Policy](#)

[< BACK](#)

Recommended

GAMING THE SYSTEM? THE CASE OF SATELLITE CASINOS IN MACAU

HONG-WAI HO

VOL. 26, NO. 5 , JUNE 2022

Regulations and Practice of Casino Reversion in Macao: What Further Should be Done?

Changbin Wang

VOL. 26, NO. 1 , FEBRUARY 2022

Nevada Regulators' Vital Role Through the Growth of Gaming

Erica Adler

VOL. 26, NO. 3 , APRIL 2022

Macau's New Gaming Legislation and Casino Post COVID-19 Recovery Considerations

GLENN MCCARTNEY

VOL. 26, NO. 8 , OCTOBER 2022

MACAU GAMING INDUSTRY 8.0—PUBLIC POLICY BEYOND 2022

Pedro Cortés

< **BACK**



© 2024 Mary Ann Liebert, Inc., publishers. All rights reserved, USA and worldwide.
Call us toll free at (800) M-LIEBERT (800-654-3237).

